PhysioHead
Physiotherapy & Behavioral Approaches in Headache Care

Comprehensive Meeting Report: PhysioHead Project

Date: April 8, 2026

Agenda: Introduction of the PhysioHead initiative's vision and mission, structuring the multidisciplinary approach around the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), outlining publication strategies (collection, book, white paper), and planning future educational activities.

1. Opening, Vision, and Multidisciplinary Approach

- The meeting commenced with a reminder that the foundational idea for the project was established approximately six months ago during discussions in Lisbon.
- The primary objective of the project is to increase the level of evidence and standardize non-pharmacological (non-drug) methods, such as physiotherapy, psychotherapy, and behavioral approaches, in the management of headache and migraine.
- It was highly emphasized that professionals working in this field need to be "open" to one another, that different disciplines should "contaminate" each other (in the sense of enriching through shared knowledge and experience), and adopt an "intra-operative" (interdisciplinary and interactive) working culture.
- The ultimate goal is not to work in isolation, but to attract and involve more people in this area, thereby building a broader professional network.

2. Core Pillar: Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)

One of the most critical strategic focal points of the meeting was shaped by the suggestion of Prof. Paolo Martelletti:

- It was agreed to establish the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) as the core pillar of the PhysioHead initiative.
- It was emphasized as highly important that specific SDG topics—particularly those related to health, education, and the reduction of inequalities—are directly linked to non-pharmacological headache care, and that the project is completely embedded within this framework.
- In this context, Alberto Raggi will circulate his "Editorial" regarding SDGs to the working group to initiate this cultural movement.

3. Publication Strategy: Collection, Book, and White Paper

The group's scientific production process was planned step-by-step with specific structural rules:

- Collection Before Book: To attract independent researchers and solo-working professionals into this cultural movement, the first step will be to create a manuscript "Collection". Following the successful establishment of this collection, the group will proceed with the Book writing phase.
- Book Project and Multinational Authorship: To maximize global inclusivity in the planned book project for Springer, a specific rule was established. It is required that each subchapter must be co-authored by two authors of different nationalities.
- White Paper / Position Paper: A short position paper evaluating non-pharmacological headache care within the context of the SDGs and a "White Paper" outlining the working group's vision will be drafted. All these consolidated ideas will be formally presented to Prof. Paolo Martelletti.

4. Global Survey and Multicenter Research

- A global survey will be planned to assess access to care, regional barriers, and attitudes toward non-pharmacological treatments across different parts of the world. The target audience of the survey (whether it will focus on physicians' perspectives or patients' access/resistance to drugs) will be clearly defined.
- The creation of multicenter databases, pooling patient data from different countries, was highlighted as a crucial step that will significantly impact global literature.

5. Educational Activities (Webinars)

- To continuously share knowledge and keep the collaborative group active, regular webinars will be organized.
- It was agreed that these should be easily organized webinars, operating without any financial benefits (non-profit), and held approximately 1 to 2 times per month/year.

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6. Action Plan and Next Steps (Action Items)

The operational steps, which will be coordinated with the help of Prof. Aynur and Licia, are defined as follows:

1. SDG Mapping: After reviewing the key messages from the Editorial to be circulated by Alberto, a concise "SDG-Headache Mapping" document will be developed to formally frame the approach.
2. Establishment of a Task Force: A small, multidisciplinary task force will be established within PhysioHead to manage these processes efficiently.
3. Collaborative Document Review: Members will begin reviewing the "Pillar Proposal", "Springer Book Proposal", and "White Paper Proposal" documents shared after the meeting. Members are explicitly requested to use the "Track Changes" feature in Word so everyone can follow the edits and suggestions.
4. Final Integration: This structured pathway will ensure that the SDG perspective is fully integrated into all academic outputs, including the white paper and the proposed book project. Once finalized, these initial steps will be communicated to Prof. Martelletti.

Sincerely,

PhysioHead Organizational Committee